



THE CANOPY

“STORIES BENEATH THE LEAVES”

THE ANNUAL MAGAZINE

1st EDITION

(2025-26)

DEPARTMENT OF FORESTRY

NORTH EASTERN REGIONAL INSTITUTE OF
SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

THE CANOPY
“Stories Beneath the leaves”

The Annual Magazine
1st Edition
(2025-26)

Department of Forestry
North Eastern Regional Institute of Science &
Technology

Deemed to be University
Nirjuli-791109, Arunachal Pradesh

THE CANOPY

Stories Beneath the Leaves

The Department of Forestry stands tall in our lives, much like a forest canopy—a sheltering presence that nurtures young, curious minds eager to explore the world of forests. Beneath its shade, we uncover the wonders of the natural world: its uses, its fragile beauty, its vital importance, and the urgent need for its conservation.

Our department does more than just impart knowledge—it roots it deep within us, kindling a profound attachment to the forests that sustain all life on earth. Each one of us carries a unique story, quietly taking shape beneath our canopy, shaped by curiosity and a deepening love for nature.

As we move forward, our shared journey remains defined by the collaboration and support we offer one another. We embrace the changes on the horizon with the same resilience as the woods we study, certain that together, we have found our way.

Welcome to “THE CANOPY – Stories Beneath the Leaves”.

This magazine is an initiative of NERIST Forestry Society (NEFOS) and published by the Department of Forestry, NERIST.

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VISION

The vision of "THE CANOPY- Stories Beneath the Leaves" is to provide an inclusive and dynamic platform for students and faculty to share their ideas, achievements, and experiences. It aims to promote creativity, critical thinking, and academic excellence by encouraging active participation and knowledge exchange.

This magazine is committed to nurturing innovative thinking, strengthening communication skills, and building a sense of community within the department. It also strives to create awareness about environmental issues and sustainable practices, aligning with the broader goals of forestry education, extension and social responsibility.

MESSAGE FROM THE DIRECTOR



Prof. Narendranath S.

It gives me immense pleasure to witness the unveiling of the inaugural edition of “THE CANOPY — Stories Beneath the Leaves,” the annual magazine of the Department of Forestry, NERIST. The launch of a departmental magazine signifies a maturing of academic identity. It serves as a vital mirror reflecting the department’s dedication to both scientific inquiry and the preservation of our natural heritage. As NERIST continues to lead the way in technical innovation, the Department of Forestry remains at the heart of our mission, cultivating the expertise and leadership necessary to navigate the complex environmental challenges of the 21st century. “THE CANOPY - Stories Beneath the Leaves” serves as a vital platform for our students and faculty to share their research, field experiences, and artistic perspectives. In the era of rapid climate change and ecological shifts, the ability to communicate scientific ideas with passion and clarity is essential. This magazine beautifully bridges that gap. I would like to extend my heartiest congratulations to the Head of the Department, the dedicated editorial board, and the student contributors who have worked tirelessly to bring this first edition to fruition. Your commitment to documenting the vibrant culture of your department is truly commendable. I am confident that this publication will become a long-standing tradition, inspiring curiosity and fostering a spirit of innovation for years to come. I wish the editorial, design team and the Department of Forestry every success in this noble endeavour.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Narendranath S.', written on a white rectangular background.

(Narendranath S)

MESSAGE FROM THE HOD



Prof. Awadhesh Kumar

Phone: +91 360 2257401-8 Extn: 7150

E-mail: hodfo@nerist.ac.in

It is a matter of great pride to introduce the first edition of "THE CANOPY- Stories Beneath the Leaves" the official magazine of our department. This initiative marks an important milestone in our journey towards fostering academic excellence and creative expression.

The magazine serves as a platform to showcase the achievements and activities of our students and faculty, while also encouraging young minds to think critically, express freely, and innovate continuously. It reflects the vibrant academic environment and collaborative spirit of our department.

I congratulate the editorial team and all contributors for their dedicated efforts in bringing out this publication. I am confident that this magazine will continue to inspire, inform, and strengthen the academic and creative culture of our department.

I extend my best wishes for its continued success in the years to come.



(Awadhesh Kumar)



ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The publication of "THE CANOPY- Stories Beneath the Leaves" is the result of collective efforts, thoughtful guidance , sincere dedication and support. We take this opportunity to express our heartfelt gratitude to all those who contributed to it's making.

We extend our sincere appreciation to our respected faculty incharge (for magazine) Prof. P.R. Gajurel, Prof. Awadhesh Kumar, Head of Department and all the esteemed faculty members for their constant support throughout the process. Their guidance has been invaluable in shaping this magazine into a meaningful reflection of our department's academic spirit and creative expression.

We are deeply grateful to our entire class for their active participation, cooperation, encouragement and contribution.

We are equally grateful to all the students whose ideas, writings, artworks and enthusiasm have given "THE CANOPY-Stories Beneath the Leaves" it's distinct voice and character.

A special word of thanks is due to the editorial and design team whose patience , commitment and meticulous efforts transformed thoughts and contribution into the form we proudly present today.

Finally we acknowledge with gratitude everyone who directly or indirectly supported this endeavor. We hope "THE CANOPY-Stories Beneath the Leaves" remains a cherished reflection of our shared experience, creativity and memories.

Chief editor's note

They say that the best time to plant a tree was twenty years ago, and the second best time is now.

I feel the same way about this magazine. As we release the 1st edition of “THE CANOPY- Stories Beneath the Leaves”, I am filled with a deep sense of sincere gratitude, and getting to lead this project as Chief Editor has been a responsibility I've held with a lot of care. But more than that, it has been a team journey. Alongside my fellow editors, design team and my classmates we have spent weeks gathering articles, poems, stories, debating designs and putting our collective energy into every page.



Our department is a hub of energy, and this magazine provides a platform that reflects our ideas, creativity, and voices. This magazine brings together our thoughts, talents, and experiences in one place. We hope this publication inspires dialogue, curiosity and renew commitment to our forests. Our goal is to ensure that

” THE CANOPY- Stories Beneath the Leaves” is as diverse and impactful as the forests we study. We hope this first edition is a sturdy start to that legacy and spirit of our batch. This magazine belongs to all of us, and we invite you to read, share, and contribute to our department's future editions as we grow together.

Best regards,
Pasang Doima (Chief Editor)
on behalf of editorial board Pasang Doima and
Riba Sangdo

Batch behind the magazine



Batch of 2023-27

FACULTIES



Prof. Awadhesh Kumar (HOD)



Prof. Binay Singh



Prof. C. L. Sharma



Prof. M. B. Sharma



Prof. Karuna Shrivastava



Prof. P. R. Gajurel



Dr. Govinda Pangging



Dr. Ashish Paul



Dr. G. Ranibala



Dr. Mihir Ranjan Panda

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DEPARTMENT OF FORESTRY



The department of forestry has come into being in 1986 along with the establishment of NERIST with an object to impart forestry education to the future generation students of eight North-Eastern states of India. The department currently offers programmes at degree (4 years B.Sc), Post graduate (2 years M.Sc) and Ph.D. levels. It is equipped with infrastructure designed to produce professional personnel with management capacity and ability to take up the future challenges in the field of forestry. This forestry courses in the institute is also an attempt to conform to National Forest Policy 1988, which emphasizes forestry education in India. North-Eastern states of India are endowed with a large forest cover which requires intellectual human resources for their conservation and sustainable management. Moreover, the region is considered as a mega biodiversity hot spot area, rich not only in biodiversity but also having many rare, endangered, threatened and endemic species, some of which may become extinct soon without human intervention. With the successful completion of their academic journey, the graduates are ready to accomplish the mission of maintaining a balance between preservation of the genetic resources and sustainable utilization of forest resources and development of the region simultaneously. The students are given exposure and training in various forest-based aspects through summer training, project and dissertation work to gain practical knowledge and skills.

The back bone of the multi-disciplinary forestry course in the institute is its faculties, who are specialized in frontier subjects i.e. forest ecology, wood science and technology, horticulture, taxonomy, ethnobotany, silviculture, biodiversity conservation, wildlife management, biotechnology, microbiology, forest genetics, forest economics ,management, environmental restoration etc. Apart from teaching and guiding students, the faculties of Forestry Department are also actively involved in conducting research work in different fields of forestry and allied subjects and guiding Ph. D scholars in their respective field of specialization. The department has produced so far more than 112 doctoral theses leading to Ph.D. degrees. The Forestry course holds greater significance as the North Eastern region has rich biodiversity which is required to be conserved and utilized on a sustainable basis. It is hoped that the forestry courses offered in NERIST will help to generate man power with better understanding of conservation aspects of natural resources and sustainable utilization of forest based products.



भारतीय वानिकी अनुसंधान एवं शिक्षा परिषद
(एनवायरनमेंट, वन एवं जलवायु परिवर्तन मंत्रालय भारत सरकार की एक स्वायत्त संस्था)
INDIAN COUNCIL OF FORESTRY RESEARCH & EDUCATION
(An autonomous Body of Ministry of Environment,
Forest & Climate Change, Govt. of India)



Certificate of Accreditation

The Accreditation Board of
The Indian Council of Forestry Research & Education
Hereby Accredits

Department of Forestry,
North Eastern Regional Institute of Science and Technology,
Nirjuli, Arunachal Pradesh
with an Overall Grade of 'A'



Dr. Vinay Kant Misra
ADG (Education & EB)
Member Secretary, Accreditation Board,
ICFRE, Dehradun

Dr. Sushil Kumar
Deputy Director General (Education)
& Chairman, Accreditation Board
ICFRE, Dehradun

Kanchan Devi
Director General,
ICFRE, Dehradun

Place: DEHRADUN
Date: 28th February, 2025

REF No. 11-50/ACC/EDU/ICFRE/755

Valid upto: 27th February, 2030

STUDENT ACHIEVEMENTS

**B.Sc GOLD MEDALIST(topper of
NERIST (2024-25))
MISS RUBU LUCY**



**M.Sc GOLD MEDALIST 2024-25
MR. VIVEK SAHU**



PLACEMENT 2025



**Toko Naniya
(Pradan)**



**Mishiki Chakma
(Pradan)**



**Neha Tabassum
(Srijan)**



**Dolly Yesmin Bora
(Pradan)**

STUDENT ACHIEVEMENTS

SYNERGY



K VICTORIA KUBA
(🏸 BADMINTON, DISCUS
THROW, FUTSAL, TT)



VAISHNAVI KUMARI
(🏓 TABLE TENNIS)



RUPAK JYOTI DAS
(🎱 CARROM, CRICKET)



LINDA CHALAMVA
(🏃 RELAY RACE)



MARRY RANGMO
(🏈 FUTSAL)



TSUJANG
(🥏 DISCUS THROW)



DAN AYE
(🏓 TABLE TENNIS)



NEHA TABASSUM & DOLLY YESMIN BORA
(🏀 BASKETBALL, VOLLEYBALL & KABADDI)



HRAVINI
(🏐 VOLLEYBALL)



RISHA, SHALINI, DIPANDITA AND HIMAN
(🏈 FUTSAL)



NATASHA MAWTHOH
(👑 SONABYSS 2K23)



K VICTORIA KUBA
(👑 SONABYSS 2K24)



TANAYA M DEKA
(👑 SONABYSS 2K25)



GOURAV NATH
(🌱 GREEN BLUEPRINT)



SANI, VICTORIA, SIARY
(🏆 ENVIROQUIZATHON)



VIEU, JONES
(🌱 GREEN
BLUEPRINT)



YADAP, PASANG AND
GOURAV
(🏆 ENVIROQUIZATHON)



GOURAV NATH
(🏆 HIGH
COMMENDATION
MUN)



HIMA WARY, GOURAV
NATH
(🏆 WASTE TO
WEALTH)



SANI, VICTORIA
(🌱 GREEN
BLUEPRINT)



TANAYA MADHUKALYA
DEKA
(🏆 DEBATE)

OTHER EVENTS



Mr. Enrique Azotus Ch Sangma
BSc. 4th year
won Alcheringa 2k25(unplugged) IIT
Guwahati

POEMS



“A Promise to the Earth”

Tell me, why do we conserve?
For the hills and mountains we preserve,
So future lives can observe,
And the green dreams we deserve.
Don't leave lonely the barren lands,
For it needs and requires your caring hands.
Plant a seed, and watch how life expands.
Heal the Earth, and let green command.
Can't you see the nature belongs to you?
So every step towards conservation begins
with you.

Care for it with all you do
And it will always care for you too.
Everybody wants millions,
but nature doesn't want any,
for saving it we may require billions.
For the destruction we have caused in trillions.
Forests give us life and air,
A silent love beyond compare.
So let's protect it while we can,
And heal the bond between earth and man.



“The Wall”

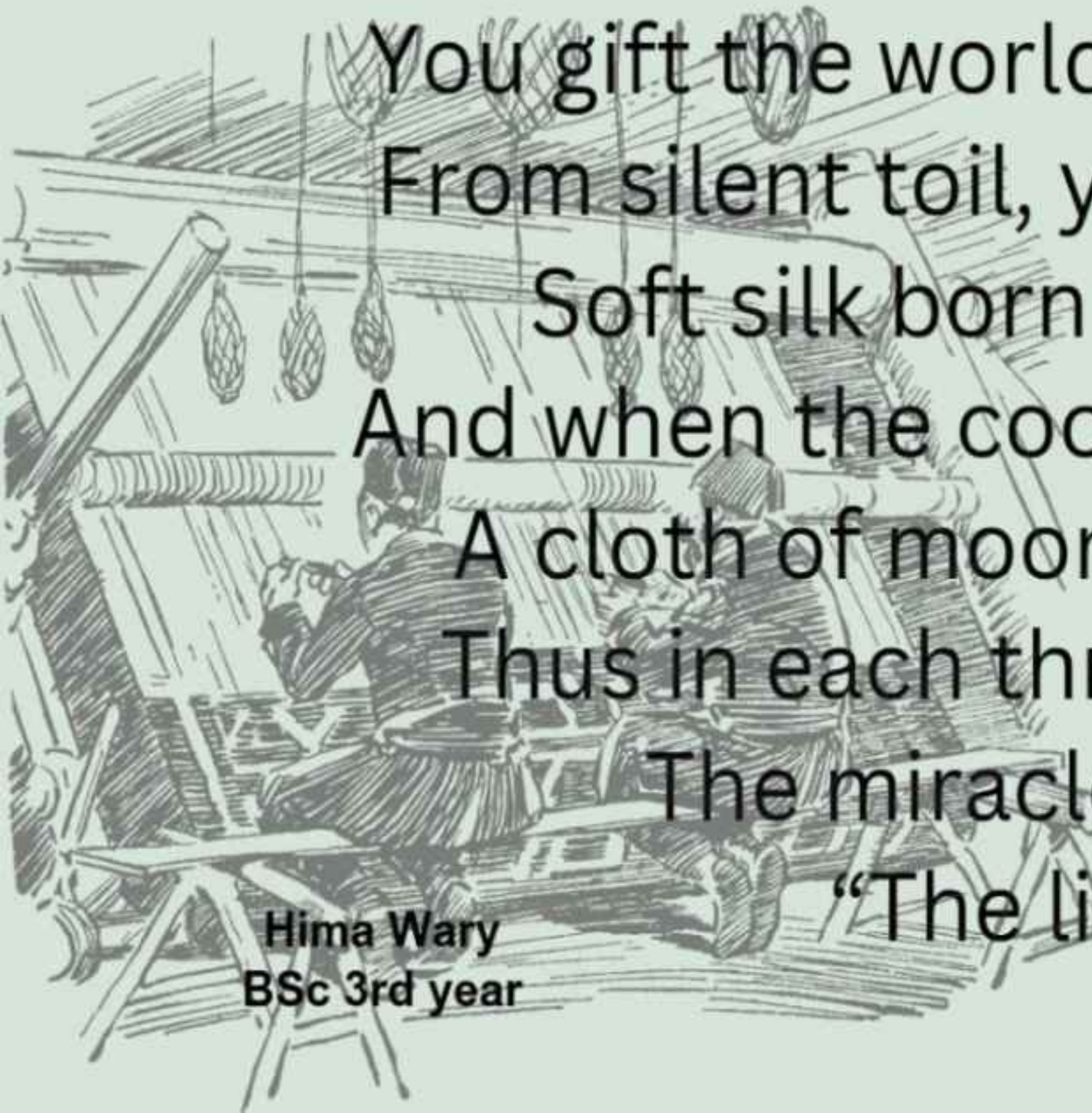
I once wrote a story
and told it to the clouds,
Somehow, unknowingly,
that story scattered across the sky.
Now, every bird flying in the sky
looks at us,
as if it wants to tell us something.
But suddenly, a wall was built,
and we can't break it
to talk to them anymore.
They are upset with us,
hurt by our actions.
And now we hear a call:
“Don't take away our home from us!
we too want peace in our home,
Not a life filled with fear of human”.

Dimpi Boruah
BSc 1st year

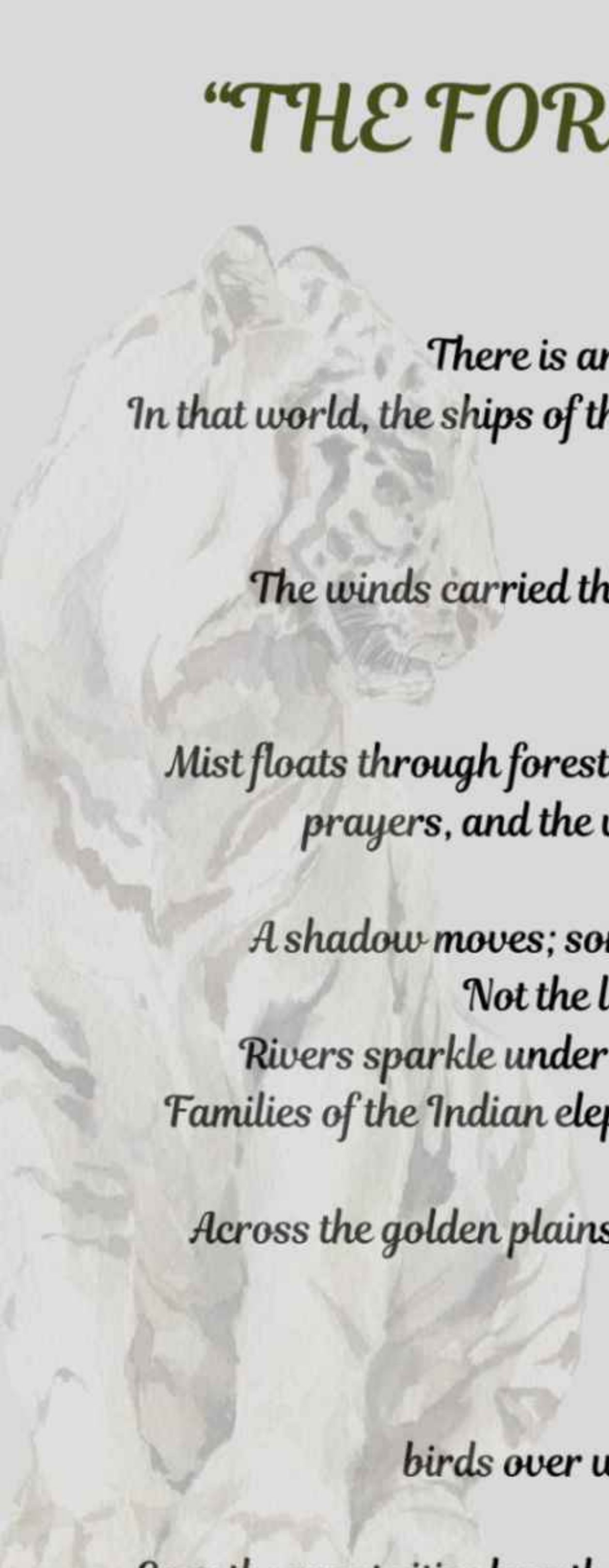
“The Little Weaver”

On a mulberry leaf, in the morning light,
A tiny worm begins its quiet rite.
No crown, no throne, no trumpet's call—
Yet softest threads will clothe us all.
It eats the leaves with patient grace,
Each bite a step in nature's pace.
Its body bends, a living loom,
Preparing silk within its womb.
No artist's brush, no sculptor's hand,
Could shape the thread it has planned.
From its humble self, it spins a shell,
A shining home it weaves so well.
Round and round the filament flows,
A silver river no one knows.
Layer on layer, smooth and tight,
A cocoon of ivory, warm and bright.
O little worm, so small, so shy,
You gift the world what kings would buy.
From silent toil, your treasure streams—
Soft silk born from leafy dreams.
And when the cocoon is gently unwound,
A cloth of moonlight is finally found.
Thus in each thread your story stays:
The miracle of simple days.

“The little weaver”



“THE FOREST THAT NEVER FELL”



*There is another India that history forgot to write.
In that world, the ships of the British East India Company never anchored the shores
of the subcontinent.*

The winds carried them elsewhere, and the land kept its ancient breath.

*Morning rises slowly there.
Mist floats through forests older than memory. Banyan roots touch the earth like
prayers, and the wind carries the scent of rain and wild jasmine.*

*A shadow moves; somewhere in the tall grass— It's a lone Bengal tiger.
Not the last, not a ghost hiding from the world.
Rivers sparkle under the sun. Along their banks walk the gentle giants –
Families of the Indian elephants move like slow thunder, following ancient paths.*

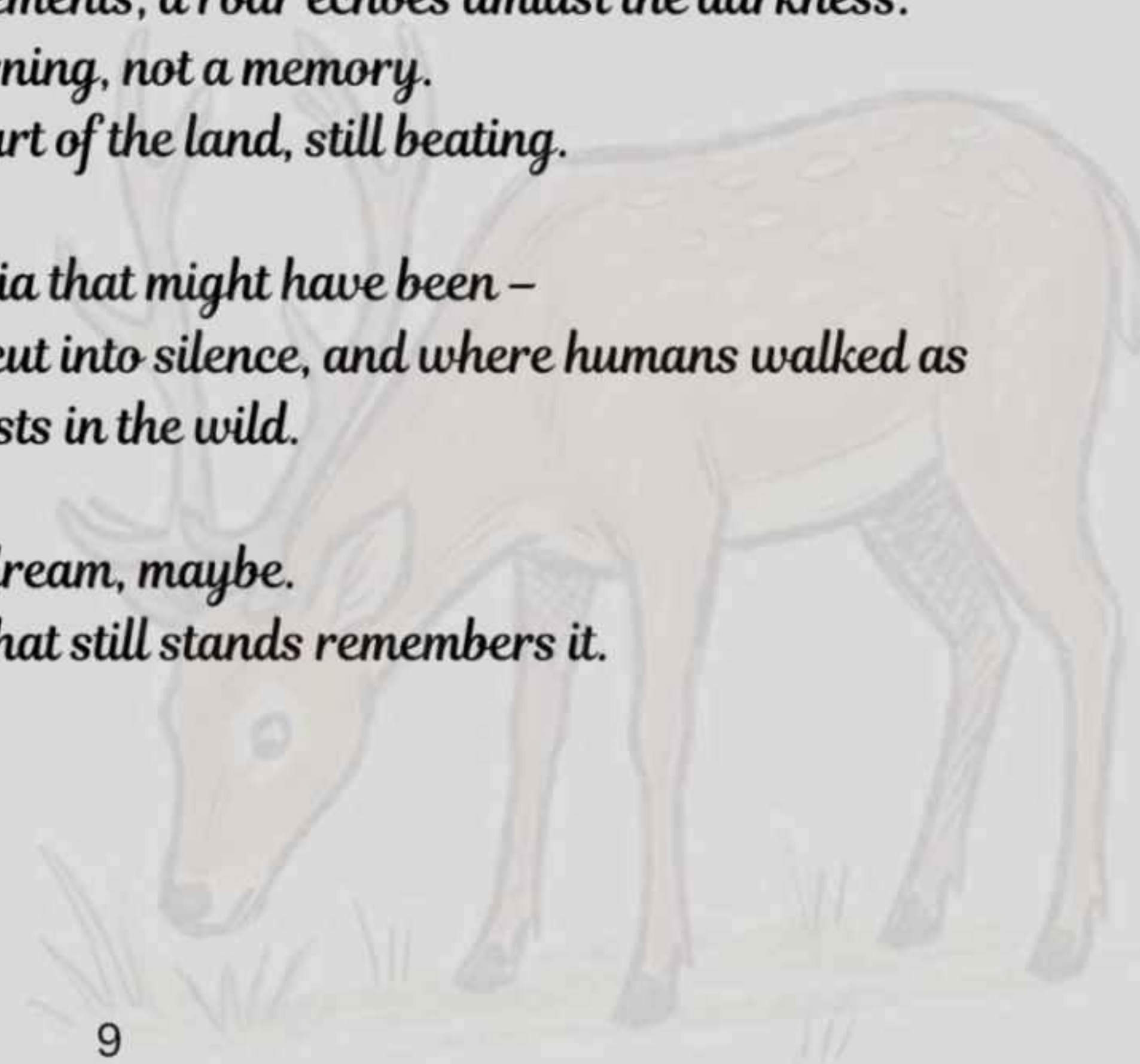
*Across the golden plains, the proud Asiatic lion roams under the burning sun.
No cages, no fences,
No dying forests.
Just the rustling of the trees,
birds over wetlands, and fireflies glowing in the night.*

Even the great cities breathe gently with the land, and the people live differently here.

*And sometimes with all the movements, a roar echoes amidst the darkness.
Not a warning, not a memory.
Just the wild heart of the land, still beating.*

*This is the India that might have been –
A country where forests were not cut into silence, and where humans walked as
guests in the wild.*

*A dream, maybe.
But every forest that still stands remembers it.*



ARTICLES



THE BATTLE BENEATH THE LAKE

A Monpa Folktale

If you've ever been to Tawang or highlands of West Kameng district of Arunachal Pradesh, you must have noticed a significant difference in the pattern of livestock rearing compared with most districts of the state. While Mithun (*Bos frontalis*) holds a central place in lives of many tribal communities across Arunachal, it is rarely seen in these two high-altitude regions. Have you ever wondered why? If not perhaps you should now.

The answer to this can be found in folktale of the Monpas which was narrated to me by my Apa (father). The story unfolds.

Hundreds of years ago, a poor man from Tawang went to Nafra (a low-altitude area in West Kameng district) in search of some work to earn money to support his family.

There, he got the opportunity to work under a farmer for one year, and by the time Losar (new year of Monpas) arrived, he requested the farmer for his wages. As his payment, the farmer gave him a Mithun. Seeing what an excellent animal the Mithun was for rearing, the man gladly accepted it and started his journey back to his home. The journey was very smooth for the man until he reached Sela (Sela pass). The lake of Sela which is considered a demon compelled to act as a guardian of the region by Padmasambhava, stopped the man and didn't let the Mithun to cross the lake. The lake challenged the man saying that it will let the Mithun cross into the region only if it first defeated the spirit of the lake. According to the belief, the spirit of the Mithun and spirit of the lake were believed to fight beneath the waters of the lake. If a milk-like substance rose to the surface, it would signify that the Mithun had won, and the lake would allow it to cross and thrive in the region. But if blood appeared on the surface instead, it would mean that the Mithun had lost and that the spirit of the lake had emerged victorious and in that case, the lake would claim both the body and spirit of the mithun, and the man would lose it forever. The man had no option but to accept the challenge.

Then the fight between the spirit of the Mithun and the spirit of the lake began beneath the water, and it continued for nearly two or three days. The man waited by the lakeside for the fight to end. After two long days, he noticed a milky substance slowly rising to the surface of the water. Seeing this, he became very happy, believing that the Mithun was winning the challenge. However, his happiness did not last long. After some time, the milky substance disappeared, and for a long time the lake remained still again. Then, gradually, a red, blood-like substance began bubbling up from the surface of the water and the surface remained red for long time. At that moment, the man understood that his Mithun had lost the fight and that the lake had emerged victorious. In this way, both the spirit and the body of the Mithun were taken by the lake. Thus, the man returned empty-handed, and from that time onwards, Mithuns could never thrive in the high-altitude regions of Tawang and West Kameng districts among the Monpa communities.



"The Song of Sangram"

When I was a child, my hometown Sangram felt like a place out of a storybook. It was surrounded by green mountains that stood tall and proud, and birds filled the sky with their song. Every morning in school, we would stand together and sing "The beauty of our little town, the hills and the valleys green".

We sang proudly because it was true. The hills were bright with trees, the valleys fresh and alive, and the air cool and clean. After school, I would run along the small paths, listening to the birds and feeling the soft grass under my feet as I watched the sunlight fall gently on the mountains. Those days felt simple and happy.

But today, when I return, I begin to notice changes. I can still see the green; it has not completely disappeared. The hills still stand, and some birds still sing, but the valleys do not shine as brightly as they once did. It feels as if a part of my childhood is slowly fading away. Even so, my heart remembers Sangram the way it used to be—covered in green, alive with birds, and filled with the sound of our morning song. I do not say it has lost its greenery completely, but I can feel it slowly changing. I hold on to the hope that one day the hills and the valleys will return to their old beauty, just as they were in my childhood memories, so that future children can sing the same song with the same pride I once did.

A Garden's Story



What truly defines the beauty of a garden? Is it merely the trees, the vibrant flowers, or the charming view? I believe the true magic lies in nature's intricate complexity- the way it guides every transformation through the rhythmic dance of the seasons. We are truly blessed to behold such exquisite and detailed creativity.

A garden that is embraced by trees that dance when the wind blows creates a forceful image of strength and resilience. Each branch that sways and each leaf that falls tells a tale of endurance. Just as the garden adapts to the biting frost of winter and the scorching heat of summer, we too find our strength in the face of change. The hues and patterns from immaculate petals of the flower, kissed by an elegant bird, draw an impeccable piece of art. It urges us to appreciate the present moment and embrace the fleeting nature of life.

The mesmerising view that any garden exists within our homes or the in the middle of busy streets is such a beauty and warmth that words are not able to convey. The boundless sky, divine clouds, gleeful trees, and the rhythmic dance of light upon the earth serve as a quiet reminder of the world's enduring grace.

Even in the chaos of our daily lives, these simple wonders offer a sanctuary for the spirit. By slowing down to witness the delicate sway of a leaf or the vastness of the horizon, we find a profound peace that grounds us, teaching us that while everything changes, the beauty of "now" is eternal.

BY- SOSOMI SHANGH
BSC 3RD YEAR

“My Polka Dot Scarf”

On my way back to university after the winter break, my friends and I wandered through the market, enjoying the last carefree moments before classes resumed. We had a good time trying outfits and admiring colorful displays. That was when I found it — a beautiful Kurti set. It had everything: a pastel-hued Kurti, matching pants, and space for the perfect dupatta. I even picked out jewelry to complete the look. The only problem was that I couldn't find the right dupatta. I searched every corner of the market for a light ivory dupatta that would perfectly complete my outfit. Shop after shop, stall after stall — nothing felt quite right. I was determined. After all, when we picture something clearly in our minds, we want it exactly that way. But then something unexpected caught my eye. Hanging quietly at a small stall was a delicate polka dot scarf — petite, simple, yet charming in its own way. It wasn't what I had been looking for; in fact, it had nothing to do with my carefully planned outfit. I hesitated. Was it practical? Would I even wear it? Or would it become just another unnecessary purchase? The vendor aunty noticed my confusion and gently asked, “Did you not find the matching dupatta?” I smiled and replied, “No... but I found this scarf instead.” She smiled warmly and said, “Then buy what you love, Beti.

” And so, I did.

Ironically, I later found the ivory-colored dupatta I had been searching for. I bought it happily, thinking my effort had finally paid off. But time revealed something interesting. The dupatta matched only one outfit, and I rarely wore it. The polka dot scarf, however, became my Favorite. It paired effortlessly with different outfits and turned out to be far more versatile than I had imagined. What began as a simple shopping trip quietly transformed into an unexpected life lesson. That small purchase taught me something meaningful: sometimes the best things in life are the ones we were not even looking for.

In life, we often chase one specific goal — a particular career path, a certain person, a fixed version of success. We feel anxious when things do not align exactly as we planned. Yet life has its own way of surprising us, unfolding paths that are far better suited for us than our original expectations. The polka dot scarf was never part of my plan, yet it became the most beautiful decision of that day — and exactly what I needed. Perhaps life works in a similar way. Sometimes what we seek at first is not what we ultimately need. It is often the unexpected and unplanned moments — the circumstances we did not choose — that gently guide us toward something far more fitting than we had imagined. What we cannot control should not consume our minds and burden our hearts. When we let go of the need to control everything, we create space for something even more meaningful to enter our lives. This feeling stays with me as I walk my path in forestry. Much like nature itself, I've realized my journey is not fixed or predictable. It grows, changes, and surprises me in ways I cannot control it. Where nature doesn't always follow human expectations, and just like forest ecosystems develop in their own way, that's the beauty of it. We'll reach where we are meant to be. Perhaps we are already where we are meant to be, and when the time is right, life quietly moves the pieces rearranging our world into something more beautiful than we could have planned ourselves.

Olivia Sangma
BSc 2nd year



SHOCKING THE RIVER TO DEATH:

HOW ELECTRIC FISHING IS QUIETLY KILLING OUR LOCAL STREAMS

Across many villages in Northeast India, a quiet but destructive habit is spreading. Instead of using traditional nets or using bamboo traps passed down through generations, some fishermen now drop electric wires connected to generators into local streams and rivers to stun and collect fish. It may seem easy and effective, but the damage it causes is enormous.

When electric current passes through water, it does more than stun the fish we see. It kills almost everything - small fish, baby fish, fish eggs, frogs, crabs, and tiny water creatures that most people never even notice. These small creatures are the very foundation of a healthy river ecosystem. When they disappear, the river slowly begins to die from within.

What makes this even more heartbreaking is that many villagers who use this method are not ill-intentioned; they are simply unaware of the damage it causes. They see a quick catch, not realizing that they are emptying the river for future generations.

Our ancestors fished using bamboo traps, hand nets, and natural plant extracts that were safe for the river. Those methods kept rivers alive and full of fish for hundreds of years. We need to return to them.

A river without fish is not just an environmental loss-it is a loss of food, culture, and livelihood for every village that depends on it.

BY - VIVEK SAHU
PHD SCHOLAR

ANE PAKKE

As someone borned in a small village of Pakke Kessang district of Arunachal Pradesh, I grew up as a close relative of forest that felt less like a place and more like a part of my soul. My village Palove (meaning a sloping piece of land) is not just a place where I come from but where my story begins. Through course of my upbringing, I have come to recognize that my attachment to forest represents a profound silence that resonates more deeply than any emotion I have ever felt. This connection has significantly influenced my thoughts, feelings and my deep connection with my land.

Ane Pakke embodies my homeland, my heritage, and my very essence. To me Pakke is far more than just a place; it's a living story woven with forests, rivers, traditions and cherished memories that I carry within me. This region is recognized as a hotspot for biodiversity, widely known for the renowned Pakke Tiger Reserve alongside three picturesque valleys: Pappu, Passa and Pakke. Pappu valley is celebrated for its vast paddy fields and is also a popular destination for paragliding. Passa valley, on the other hand is admired for its breathtaking landscape and natural beauty. Pakke valley is home to district headquarter Lemmi, a place known for its pleasant weather even during the summer months. Pakke has tropical semi-evergreen forests which play a vital role in sustaining its rich biodiversity.



Pakke Kesang is surrounded by other adjoining districts : West Kameng to the west, East Kameng to the northwest, Kra Daadi to the east, Papum Pare and Assam to the south. It also features Naksaparvat, an underexplored archaeological site at Dissing Passo village, dated back to 14th-15th century, the site showcases the ancient architectural legacy of Ahom Kingdom, which is preserved by the state government.

One of the precious gems of Ane Pakke is the Pakke Tiger Reserve, home to a vibrant forest ecosystem that supports a diverse array of wildlife. This lush area is inhabited by tigers, elephants, hornbills and boasts around 1,500 plant species, 103 mammals species, 385 butterflies, 300+ moth species and 296 bird species, including the endangered white winged woodduck and 4 species of hornbills which reflects the region's high biodiversity value and conservation significance. Being a daughter of this land I feel a deep sense of responsibility to protect and preserve this natural heritage.

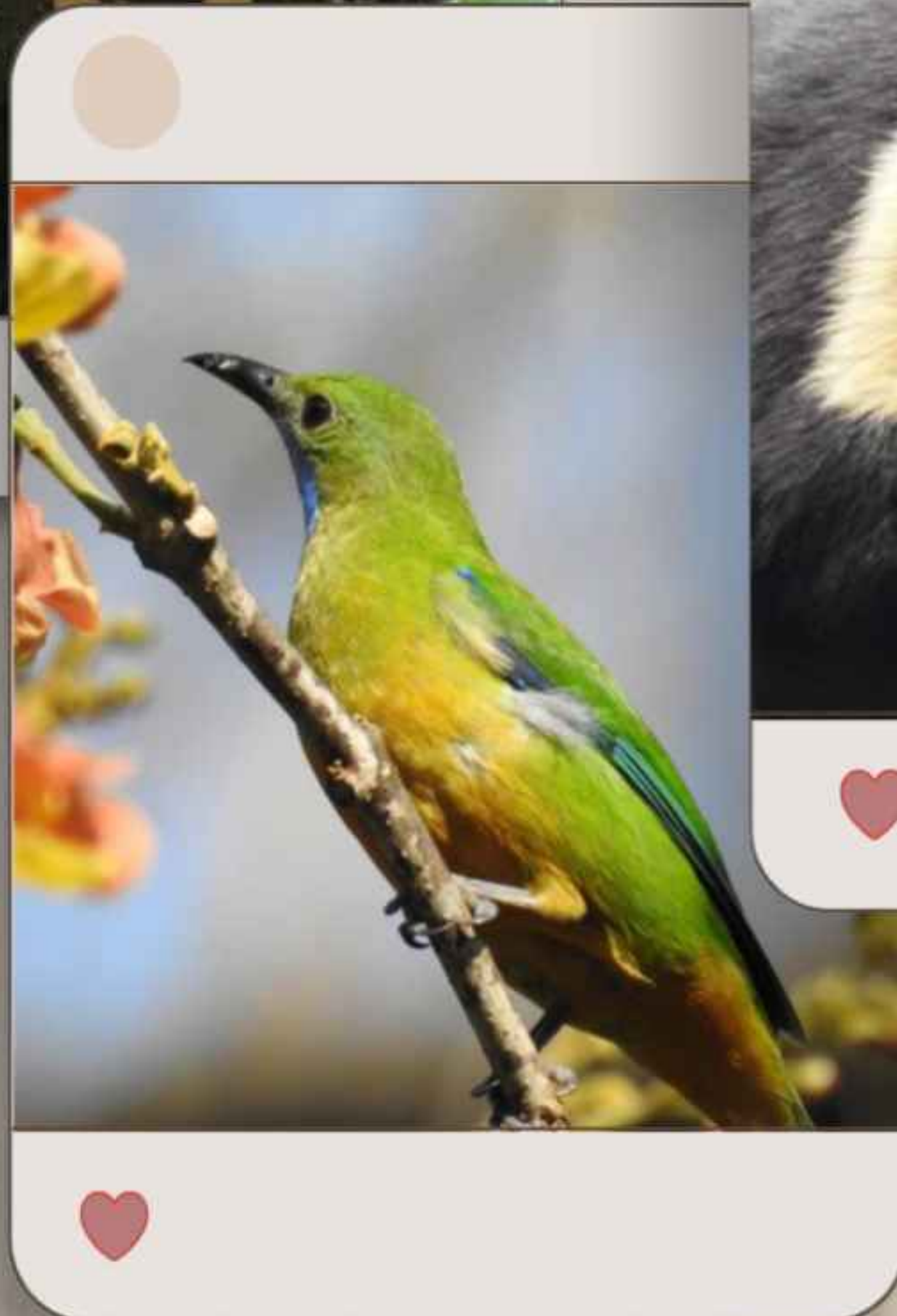
The Nyishi community residing in Pakke has historically maintained a symbiotic relationship with nature which can be seen in their traditional practices through the preservation of traditional knowledge passed down from their ancestors. The Pakke Paga festival, conducted annually at Seijosa is an initiative aimed at safeguarding endangered hornbills and their habitats. This celebration serves to recognize the Nyishi community's dedication to hornbills' conservation featuring a variety of activities that promote wildlife appreciation, cultural heritage, and ecotourism. One of the notable aspects of the Nyishi community's approach to conservation is, their decision to utilize artificial hornbill headgear rather than resorting to the killing of hornbills for their beaks while conserving their culture at the same time.

I grew up listening to the folk stories my parents narrated, where Tigers were revered as our elder brother, and Drongo as the avian monarch, along with the tales of forest spirit "yapum" a dwarf human like entity believed to inhabit the woods. All these narratives have deepened my connection to my cultural heritage.

The forest taught me how to be humble and heal when world is dark which eventually influenced me to choose Forestry as my major, and now I can proudly say I love knowing more about forest.



PHOTOGALLERY



1

Columba hodgsonii
@Lemchai Pansa



2

Otus bakkamoena
@Lemchai Pansa



3

Aethopyga ignicauda
@Lemchai Pansa



4

Buceros bicornis
@Riba sangdo



5

Rhyticeros undulatus
@Yadap Tok

6

Anorrhinus austen
@Lemchai Pansa



7

Papilio paris
@Lemchai Pansa



8

Attacus atlas
@Salini Jamatia



9

Agathia laetata
@Risha Chakma



10

Trachypithecus pileatus
@Lemchai Pansa



11

Paradoxurus hermaphroditus
@Lemchai Pansa

12

Byasa polyeutes
@Vivek Sahu



13

Tamiops mccllellandii
@Vevik Sahu



14

Rucervus eldii eldii
@Tanaya Madhukalya Deka



15

Axis porcinus
@Prof.Awadhesh kumar



16

**Keoladeo National Park
@Yadap Tok**



17

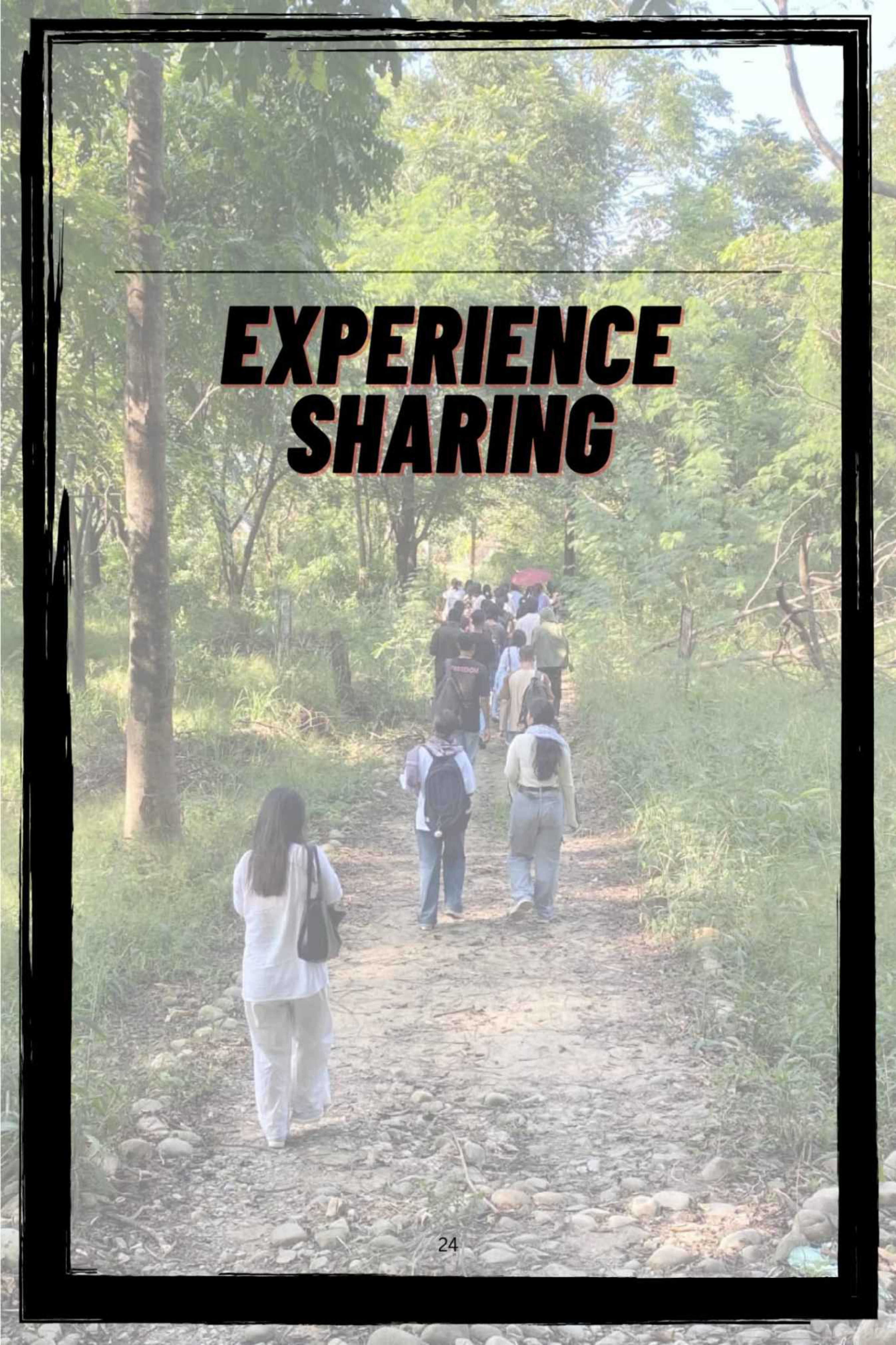
***Ficus racemosa*
@ Riba Sangdo**



18

**Kaziranga National Park
@Eureka Baruah**



A group of people, mostly seen from behind, are walking along a dirt path that is strewn with small stones. The path leads into a dense forest with tall trees and lush green foliage. Sunlight filters through the leaves, creating a dappled light effect on the ground. The people are dressed in casual attire, and some are carrying backpacks. The overall atmosphere is peaceful and suggests a group outing or a hike.

EXPERIENCE SHARING

MY FIRST INTERNSHIP AT PAKKE TIGER RESERVE

On 12 December 2024, I, Riba Sangdo, a second-year B.Sc. Forestry student, received a call from the Head of our Department informing me that I had been selected for a one-month internship program at Pakke Tiger Reserve (PTR) along with 16 other students from different batches, including juniors, batchmates, and seniors from the final year and M.Sc. programs.

After completing our end-semester examinations, we left for PTR on 15 December 2024. The internship lasted for one month, from 15 December 2024 to 16 January 2025. During this internship, we were involved in various activities such as Tiger Conservation Projects (TCP), and surveys on human-wildlife conflict in villages near the reserve—particularly focusing on small cats—and extracting photographs captured through camera traps, which was a completely new experience for all of us. We reached the Seijosa range at 10:40 am, where we were allotted rooms in separate dormitories for boys and girls. The campus where we were staying was known as West Bank. The dormitory was clean, hygienic, and surrounded by lush greenery and a beautiful butterfly park was located nearby. One of the best parts of this internship was that it was a paid programme. Our food and lodging were provided by the Forest Department, and in addition to that, we also received a stipend along with an experience certificate.

On the first day, there were no officials present to guide us regarding our work. So, we decided to plan our own schedule. We started our day with breakfast at 6 a.m. and worked until lunch at around 1 p.m, after which we resumed our work again until 4 or 5 p.m. The officials had provided us with a conference hall where we carried out most of our technical work. For the first 10–15 days, we mainly worked on extracting photographs from camera traps and preparing questionnaires for the village surveys.

After a few days, the field biologist at PTR, Chandan Sir, arrived and started guiding us in our work. His presence made a huge difference, and our work progressed almost twice as fast. Under his guidance, we completed the work related to TCP, finalized the questionnaire for the survey, and started preparing ourselves for the field surveys in the nearby villages.



On 9 January 2025, we began our survey in the villages near the Seijosa Range. We were divided into teams of two to three people. Along with one of my seniors, I was assigned to conduct the survey in Niti Darlong, where we visited around six to nine houses. It was a completely new experience for me. Being an introvert, speaking with random people felt very difficult at first. However, as the day progressed, I slowly gained confidence in interacting with strangers. Looking back, I feel that this experience helped me grow personally and pushed me out of my comfort zone.

During the survey, we interacted with many people from different backgrounds. Some villagers were very welcoming and cooperative, while others were a bit rude or hesitant to talk to us. By the end of the day, we returned to our dormitory around 3 p.m., exhausted and with empty stomachs. Despite the tiredness, we felt happy and satisfied that we had successfully completed our survey work within the given time.

Our next task was to go to Tippi Range, Bhalukpong, where we had to continue our survey. We left for Tippi on 10 Jan 2025 and reached there at approximately 4 pm. Then we were allotted rooms near the RFO quarter, where we had dinner which was cooked by Chandan sir. After dinner, one memorable incident occurred when my friend and I made the rather foolish decision to set up a tent outside the house and sleep outdoors. That night turned out to be both memorable and terrifying. After 8 pm, strong winds began to blow, and our tent was almost carried away by the wind. Because of the extremely windy conditions, we barely managed to sleep for three to four hours.

The next morning we freshened up and met the RFO of Tippi, Kime Rambia sir. We gave our brief introduction, and he assigned us to different places for the survey. I was assigned to the farthest village, Kimi, along with one forest guard. We started our journey on a Pulsar bike travelling along a kachcha road, and we encountered an unexpected roadblock, which resulted in a considerable delay. Somehow, we reached there and I completed my survey work successfully. While returning, I was so happy and satisfied. Then we stopped at a forest beat office and had maggi there, the forest guards shared their problems which were interesting. I was also surprised and happy to meet a person from my hometown who was working there as a forest guard.

Our plan was to complete the survey and head back the same evening to Seijosa, but due to incompleteness of survey by my other co-surveyors and my late arrival, my friend Kuru Radhe, a junior, Sunny bhai and I had to stay back to complete the remaining works. So, the next day we woke up at 5 am, ate our breakfast, and went for the survey, where I met many people from my hometown, even my dad's friends. After an hour of completing our survey, we went to the Tippi Orchid Research Centre, Asia's largest Orchid Research Center. The RFO sir had invited us for lunch at his house, which was very tasty. Then we came back to Seijosa with RFO sir by his car, on the way he shared many experiences and his knowledge related to forestry, which made our journey with him even more interesting. Then we were planned to go to Rilloh Range for a survey. However, owing to unavoidable circumstances and the commencement of our classes, we were unable to go there and thus concluded our internship at PTR Seijosa.

Some of the most memorable moments of the internship were the early morning treks inside the forest in search of wildlife. During these treks, we were fortunate to see several animals, including elephants, barking deer, sambar deer, jungle fowl, and porcupines. We also observed many fascinating birds such as the Great hornbill, wreathed hornbill, minivets, barbets, drongos, different species of bulbul and khalij pheasants. One particularly thrilling moment occurred when we encountered a large king cobra during our trek.

After hectic work we used to have campfires outside our dormitory while roasting meat at the same time. We also celebrated our Christmas & New Year together and enjoyed it so much. I was so comfortable with everyone there that I didn't even miss my family during the entire internship.

Our DFO sir was so generous that he even planned one day safari for us where we went inside the core of the PTR (Khari beat and Upper Dekorai) where we came across many birds such as, Jungle Fowl, Khalij Pheasant, and Giant squirrels and even langurs. We also visited the bear rehabilitation center and also saw a rescued cub of a leopard cat.

This internship was not only a valuable professional exposure but also a significant journey of personal growth. The knowledge we gained during this period was far beyond what we learn in classrooms. It helped us develop communication skills, discipline, punctuality, and a deeper understanding of wildlife conservation and forest management.



Riba Sangdo
BSc. 3rd year

CHESSA TRIP

On 6th September 2025, we had our very first field trip as first-year students, and honestly, it felt like the real beginning of college life. We went to Chessa early in the morning with Mihir Sir, other department faculty members, and a few PhD scholars. We reached around 8:00 AM, with all of us carrying heavy bags filled with first-aid kits and snacks because we truly had no idea what to expect. And we were right to be prepared. We walked for hours. It was tiring, the forest paths were uneven, and leeches were everywhere—many of us had them on our legs. There were insect bites, sweat, and moments when we questioned our stamina. But at the same time, there was excitement. This wasn't classroom learning anymore; this was real-life experience.



6th September 2025

We also met a tour guide who was very friendly and had extensive knowledge of the species found there. During the survey, we identified more than 300 species in total, including around 60 species of bamboo. Out of those, we managed to identify almost 30 species ourselves, which felt like such an achievement. Among them all, my personal favorite was *Pseudosasa japonica*. It was small and very delicate—and knowing that it has remained almost the same for nearly 50 years made it even more special to me. It felt simple but strong, and I found it really adorable. Another unforgettable sight was *Lagerstroemia speciosa*, also known as the Pride of India. It was so beautiful and vibrant that it instantly caught everyone's attention. Seeing it in real life felt different from just reading about it in books.

We visited various nurseries and flower gardens. There, we saw ornamental plants, medicinal plants, orchards, and even greenhouses with different cactus species. One thing that really stayed with me was realizing how almost everything we use in our daily lives somehow comes from forests like this. It made me respect nature even more. Lunchtime was honestly one of the best parts. The food tasted extra good because we were exhausted, and eating together made it even better. Some of us even took a short nap before continuing our survey. Even though we were physically drained, no one wanted the day to end. As the Class Representative, this trip was also special for me in another way. Collecting funds, coordinating with everyone, and making sure things went smoothly were responsibilities I genuinely enjoyed. It felt good to take leadership and not disappoint my classmates. Being trusted by my batch means a lot to me, and experiences like this make me want to do even better. We returned around 4:30 pm—tired, bitten by insects, slightly messy but happy. More than the species identification, what I will remember most is the bonding. As a batch, we grew closer. We laughed, struggled, helped each other, and even got closer to Mihir Sir and our PhD scholars. Yes, the trip was exhausting. Yes, there were obstacles. But above all, it was memorable. It was our first field trip—and I think it will always remain one of the most special experiences.

Jing Panggeng
BSc 1st year

From Theory to Terrain:

A hands on forestry internship experience

I, Srijita Deb Roy, a student at NERIST, had the opportunity to participate in a field-based forestry internship conducted at Tripura University from 15th December to 3rd January. The internship primarily focused on the identification and documentation of tree species through systematic field surveys.

The major task during the internship was identifying tree species and recording detailed information for each species. This included the measurement of tree parameters, assessment of tree health, documentation of accessory herbs and shrubs, and noting wildlife observed in the survey areas. The Latitude and longitude of each location were recorded to ensure accuracy and proper documentation.

Field surveys were carried out across varied locations, including the Tripura University campus, a roadside plantation, a public park, a hospital area, and a lakeside ecosystem. Surveys were conducted from morning till evening, allowing exposure to diverse ecological settings and vegetation types.

At the end of the internship, a comprehensive survey report covering all recorded parameters was prepared and submitted in both hard-copy and soft-copy formats. On successful completion, an internship completion certificate was awarded. This internship proved to be a valuable learning experience and strengthened my practical understanding of forestry fieldwork.



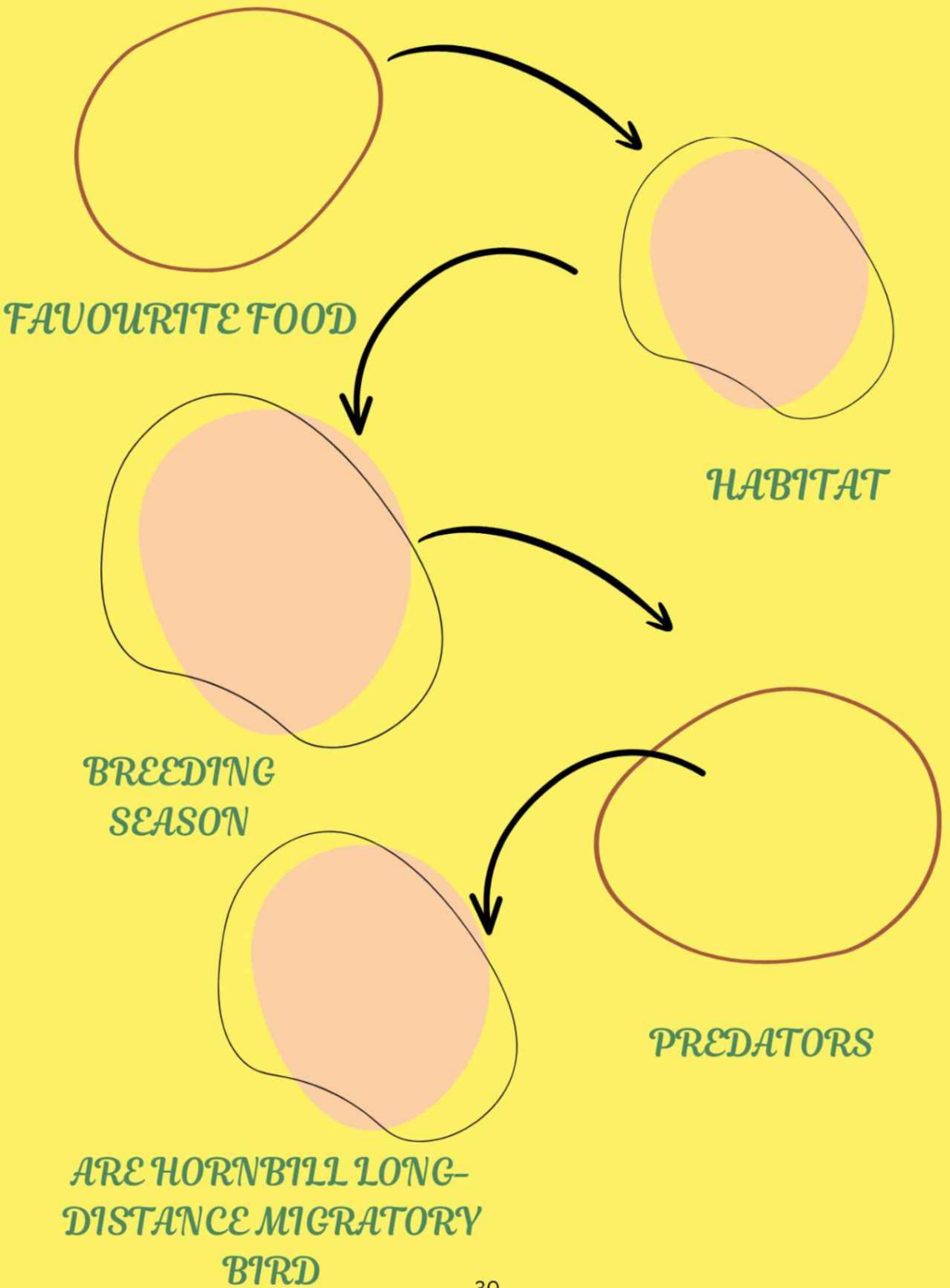
Srijita Deb Roy
Bsc. 1st year



**DID YOU
KNOW ?**

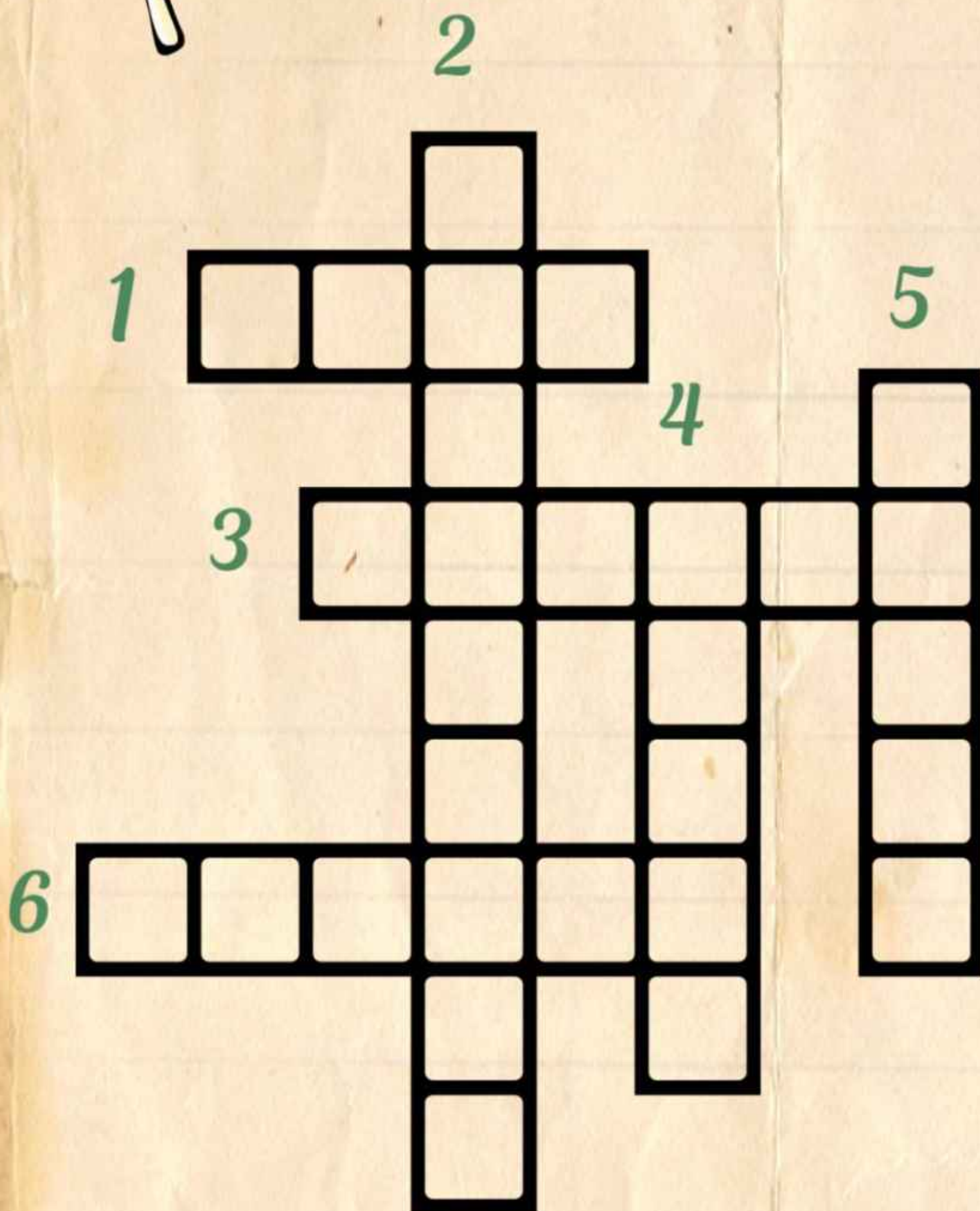


5 FACTS ABOUT THE GREAT HORNBILL

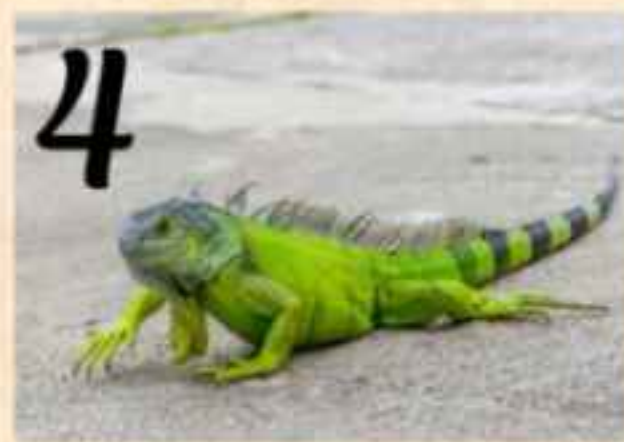




CROSSWORD PUZZLE



HINT PICTURES



Quiz Time

Q1. You’ve got your camera ready, hoping to snap the perfect shot of the newly “rediscovered” Namdapha flying squirrel. Where are you trekking

A. The mangrove swamps of west bengal

B. The pristine evergreen forest of arunachal pradesh

C. The high-altitude sholas of kerela

D. The arid scrub lands of rajasthan

Q2. Loktak Lake is recognised under which international convention?

A. UNESCO World Heritage

B. Kyoto Protocol

C. Ramsar Convention

D. Paris Agreement

Q3. Which endangered species is famous in Manas National Park?

A. One-horned rhinoceros

B. Nilgiri tahr

C. Lion-tailed macaque

D. Blackbuck

Q4. You spot a vibrant, purplish-blue flower carpeting the hillsides. Locals tell you it's incredibly rare because it only blooms once every 12 years. What did you just find?

A. Neelakurinji

B. Palash(Flame of the forest)

C. Indian Wild Orange

D. Scared Grove Orchids

Q5. Which is the world's most expensive spice, and is made from the dried stigmas of its flower?

A. Vanilla

B. Cardamom

C. Saffron

D. Black pepper

Q6. The Amur Falcon migrates to India from which region?

A. Africa

B. Europe

C. Siberia

D. Australia

Q7. The name of Agartala reflects the abundance of which tree species?

A. *Azadirachta indica*

B. *Tectona grandis*

C. *Aquilaria malaccensis*

D. *Shorea robusta*

Q8. Sikkim is widely recognised for its achievement of becoming India's first fully?

A. Industrial state

B. Organic farming state

C. Desert state

D. Coastal state

WORD SEARCH



H	R	G	H	O	S	T	O	R	C	H	I	D	B
O	M	P	P	O	L	A	R	B	E	A	R	U	K
O	N	R	E	D	P	A	N	D	A	T	G	N	G
L	O	S	P	A	S	A	N	G	S	U	U	S	H
O	W	A	G	R	H	I	M	A	N	E	L	N	A
C	P	L	O	I	O	Q	G	L	V	O	Q	O	R
K	E	I	U	B	G	R	I	O	T	D	S	W	I
G	T	N	R	A	T	O	N	H	K	O	A	L	A
I	R	J	V	R	C	S	S	J	B	I	L	E	L
B	A	A	F	I	Y	A	D	A	P	M	P	O	H
B	L	M	C	S	P	E	N	G	U	I	N	P	Z
O	A	H	G	H	R	U	P	A	K	J	Y	A	V
N	L	T	R	A	F	F	L	E	S	I	A	R	H
A	D	I	P	A	N	D	I	T	A	W	R	D	T



RED PANDA

SNOW LEOPARD

GHARIAL

RAFFLESIA

GHOST ORCHID

BUGUN LIOTCHLA

HOG
PLATYPUS

PENGUIN
KOALA

SLOTHS

POLAR BEAR

HOOLOCK GIBBON

SNOW PETREL

Departmental



Activities

ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

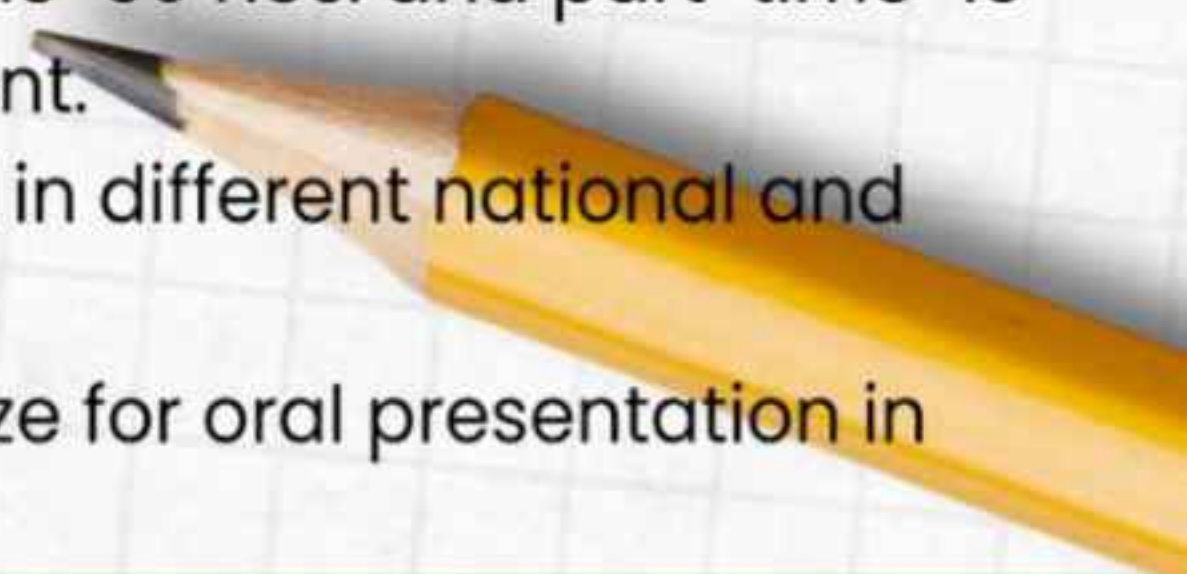


Regular classes are held for core subjects such as forest ecology, silviculture, wildlife management, forest mensuration, forest conservation etc. Practical sessions form an important part of learning, where students are trained in tree identification, measurement of forest parameters, and nursery techniques. Laboratory work includes soil analysis, seed testing, and study of plant specimens. Students are also engaged in assignments, record preparation, and internal assessments such as unit tests and viva to strengthen their understanding. These academic activities help in developing technical knowledge and preparing students for field-based forestry works.

RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT



- The department has awarded **12 PhDs in 2025** and has produced over **112 PhDs** till date with fostering expertise in forestry and natural resource management in the North Eastern region
- Total 11 new Ph.D. students were registered for their Ph.D. degree in both sessions ,July-Dec. 2025 and Jan.-May 2026.
- At present, a total number of 44 Ph.D. scholars (both full-time-30 nos. and part-time-13 nos.) are actively engaged in research within the department.
- In the year 2025, a total of 26 research papers is published in different national and international peer reviewed journals.
- Mr.Bhaskar Jyoti Sharma and Ms.Tage Yama recieved 1st prize for oral presentation in national conference.



FACULTY RECOGNITION



Prof. Padma Raj Gajurel was honored with a new species (***Ophiorrhiza gajureliana & Crotalaria gajureliana***) named after him in recognition of his significant contributions to plant taxonomy.

SEMINARS



Regular workshops and seminars are organised to enhance students' knowledge and awareness about current environmental issues. Recently on **23rd February 2026** a seminar was held on the topic "**How to Conserve Biodiversity-Rich Ecosystems of Arunachal Pradesh Amidst Development?**" delivered by **Dr. Rajkamal Goswami**. On **5th February 2026** a one-day workshop on "**Wildlife Conservation Tools and Techniques**" in collaboration with the Wildlife Trust of India and Arunachal Pradesh State Forest Department was conducted, where students from Rajiv Gandhi University also participated and certificates were also awarded to the participants. Another informative session on '**Geospatial Data: Analysis and Modelling**' was delivered by **Mr. Parthiv Naraya** (an alumnus of NERIST) where students learned about the use of geospatial technology in environmental monitoring and data analysis.



WORKSHOP AND FIELD EXTENSION TRAINING ORGANIZED



- ✓ Five Days workshop on “Bioinformatics for Forestry and Agricultural Research” in collaboration with NIELIT was organized at Department of Forestry, NERIST, Itanagar from 3-7th April 2025.
- ✓ One day workshop on “Fodder and Livestock based Intervention for Livelihood Improvement of NEH Farmers” was organized at Bhogpur, North Lakhimpur, Assam on 23rd February 2025.
- ✓ One day workshop on “Fodder and Livestock based Intervention for Livelihood Improvement of NEH Farmers” was organized at Homora, Narayanpur, Assam on 8th March 2025.
- ✓ Two days training programme on “Bamboo and its Potential for Livelihood” was organized at Department of Forestry, NERIST from 19th – 20th March 2025
- ✓ One day training on “Fodder and Livestock based Intervention for Livelihood Improvement of NEH Farmers” was organized at Sadiya Assam on 31st March 2025
- ✓ One Day workshop on “Survey methodology to understand the behavioural and cultural drivers of bear hunting” was organized at Seijosa, Pakke Tiger Reserve in collaboration with Wildlife Trust of India (WTI), Noida on 6th September 2026.
- ✓ One-Day Workshop on “Wildlife conservation tools and Techniques” was organized at Department of Forestry, NERIST in collaboration with WTI, Noida on 3rd February 2026.



FIELD VISITS



As part of our course, each batch visits designated sites of importance. Visits made during:

- ✓ BSc 1st year are : Van Vigyan Kendra Chessa and other relevant sites nearby like poultry farms, fish farms and nurseries of Nirjuli and adjoining areas
- ✓ BSc 2nd year are : Naara Aaba winery ,CEKF (Centre of Excellence For Kiwi) Ziro, Itanagar zoological Park, and Namdapha National Park /Eaglenest Wildlife sanctuary
- ✓ BSc 3rd year are : Pakke Tiger Reserve, KVK Lakhimpur, State museum Itanagar, CHF Pasighat and all India tour (northern or southern India),this year(2025-26) the students chose northern India.
- ✓ BSc 4th year are : PTC Banderdewa, Bamboo Technological Park Poma and State Forest Research Institute (SFRI) Chimpur.

CLEANLINESS AND PLANTATION DRIVE



Cleanliness and plantation drives are conducted on regular basis in our department and NERIST campus. As part of **Swachhata Pakhwada 2025**, the Department of Forestry conducted campus plantation drive on **11 September 2025**. Nursery cleanliness drives were held on 7 September 2025 and 15 February 2026.



PICTURES RELATED TO

(FIELD VISITS, WORKSHOPS,SEMINERAS,, RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT ETC.)



MSc final year at INDUSTRY-ACADEMIA MEET



Bsc 3rd year at Namdapha



Nursery cleanliness drive



*SWACHHATA PAKHWADA-2025
plantation and cleanliness drive*



Presentation by Dr. Rajkamal Goswami (ATREE)



Adress by Shri Millo Tasser (TFS)

ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES



BSc 3rd year at KVK Lakhimpur



BSc 2nd year at departmental fresher's meet 2025



BSc 1st year at VVK Chessa



Director sir at VVK Chessa



BSc 4th year at PTC Banderdewa



Faculties with resource persons on ONE-DAY WORKSHOP ON "WILDLIFE CONSERVATION TOOLS AND TECHNIQUES"

NOTABLE ALUMNI



*Ms. Koj Rinya
[1995 NERIST batch]
TFS 2006 batch*



*Mr. Pee Lee Ete (Nyali Ete)
[1996 NERIST batch]
TFS 2008 batch*



*Ms. Tripti Sah
[1996 NERIST batch]
TFS 2008 batch*



*Mr. R.K. Amarjit Singh
[1994 NERIST batch]
TFS 2009 batch*



*Mr. Millo Tasser
[2002 NERIST batch]
TFS 2009 batch*



*Mr. Supong Sashi
[1999 NERIST batch]
TFS 2010 batch*



*Mr. Sanjib Das
[2004 NERIST batch]
TFS 2011 batch*



*Mr.s. Khelen Singh
[2002 NERIST batch]
TFS 2012 batch*



*Ms. L. C. Bandana
[2002 NERIST batch]
TFS 2012 batch*

NOTABLE ALUMNI



Mr. Pritam Bhattacharya
[1993 NERIST batch]
TFS 2012 batch



Mr. Beizo Suokhrie
[1993 NERIST batch]
TFS 2014 batch



Mr. Krishna Gopal Roy
[1994 NERIST batch]
TFS 2015 batch



Ms. Paushali Roy
[2003 NERIST batch]
TFS 2015 batch



Mr. Suman Malla
[2002 NERIST batch]
TFS 2017 batch



Ms. L. Jeecelee
[2007 NERIST batch]
TFS 2026 batch



Mr. D. Jhon Sha
[2008 NERIST batch]
TFS 2026 batch



Ms. E. Nirmala Chanu
[2013 NERIST batch]
TFS 2026 batch

The Team Behind the pages

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Pasang Doima



Riba Sangdo

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Yadap Tok



Rupak Jyoti Das



Salini Jamatia



Dipandita Minz



Risha Chakma



Gourav Nath

